

GOD OF WAR

The Complete Guide — Legacy, Lore & Legacy

Overview

God of War is one of the most acclaimed action-adventure video game franchises in history, developed by Santa Monica Studio and published by Sony Interactive Entertainment. Beginning in 2005, the series follows **Kratos** — a Spartan warrior turned Greek God of War — through mythologies spanning Greece and Norse worlds. Renowned for its epic storytelling, visceral combat, and stunning visuals, God of War has defined a generation of gaming.

Game Timeline

Year	Title	Setting	Platform
2005	God of War	Ancient Greece	PS2
2007	God of War II	Ancient Greece	PS2
2010	God of War III	Mount Olympus	PS3
2013	God of War: Ascension	Greece (Prequel)	PS3
2018	God of War (Reboot)	Norse Mythology	PS4
2022	God of War: Ragnarok	Norse — Nine Realms	PS4/PS5

Kratos — The Ghost of Sparta

Kratos is one of gaming's most iconic protagonists. Born a Spartan warrior, he was tricked by Ares into killing his own family, marking him forever with their ashes — giving him his trademark ghostly white skin. His journey of vengeance against the gods drives the original trilogy. In the 2018 reboot, an older, more restrained Kratos navigates the Norse realms alongside his son **Atreus**, exploring themes of fatherhood, grief, and redemption.

Why God of War Matters

- **Groundbreaking Narrative:** The 2018 reboot is told in a single unbroken camera shot, a cinematic achievement rarely seen in gaming.
- **Mythology Mastery:** The series faithfully adapts and reimagines Greek and Norse mythologies, introducing millions to these rich traditions.
- **Emotional Depth:** The father-son dynamic between Kratos and Atreus brought a new emotional layer, earning critical and fan acclaim worldwide.
- **Combat Excellence:** The Leviathan Axe (2018) and Blades of Chaos are considered some of the most satisfying weapons ever designed in games.
- **Cultural Impact:** With over 35 million copies sold across the franchise, God of War is a defining pillar of PlayStation's identity.

Key Characters

Character	Role	Mythology
Kratos	Protagonist / God of War	Greek & Norse
Atreus (Loki)	Kratos's son, demi-god	Norse
Zeus	King of Olympus, antagonist	Greek
Odin	Allfather, primary villain	Norse
Thor	Norse God of Thunder	Norse
Freya	Vanir goddess, ally/enemy	Norse

Awards & Recognition

God of War (2018) swept the Game Awards, winning **Game of the Year** along with Best Narrative, Best Score/Music, and Best Art Direction. God of War: Ragnarok (2022) received over 200 Game of the Year nominations and won numerous awards for narrative excellence and sound design. The series holds a legacy Metacritic score above 93 for its latest entries.

Fun Facts

- The Blades of Chaos were originally a gift from Ares to Kratos, permanently chained to his forearms.
- Christopher Judge, who voices Kratos in the Norse saga, delivered the line 'Boy!' that became a beloved internet meme.
- The 2018 game's single-shot camera was inspired by films like Birdman and 1917.
- Atreus is revealed to be the Norse trickster god Loki — his mother was a giant named Faye (Laufey).
- God of War: Ragnarok features over 75 playable characters and enemies drawn from Norse legends.

"The cycle ends here. We must be better than this." — Kratos, God of War (2018)
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